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Army Promotion Board Study Guide

NCO / Soldier of the Month & Semi-Centralized Promotion Boards
Organized by regulation · Open-ended Q&A + Multiple choice

Compiled June 2026 · Reflects current Army doctrine including the Army Fitness Test (AFT), the AR 600-9
Waist-to-Height standard, and the September 2025 AR 670-1 grooming directive.

Read this first — accuracy & how to use this guide

This is an unofficial study aid. Army regulations and doctrine change frequently. Every effort has been made to reflect the most current publications as of **June 2026**, with citations to the governing publication. **Always confirm answers against the official publication on armypubs.army.mil and with your unit's board NCO / president of the board.** Local boards may weight subjects differently and may use the board recorder's own answer key. Where a fact could not be fully verified it is marked "*verify locally*."

HOW A BOARD WORKS

- **Appearance & bearing first.** Reporting procedures, uniform, and military bearing are graded before you answer a single knowledge question.
- **Open-ended questions.** Real boards are oral. Members ask a question and you answer aloud — so practice *saying* the answers, not just recognizing them. That is why this guide gives the open-ended Q&A first.
- **Know the source.** Strong answers cite the publication ("Per AR 670-1..."). The multiple-choice sections reinforce the same facts for quick self-testing.
- **"Which regulation covers...?"** Board members love regulation-identification questions. A dedicated section for these is at the front of this guide.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Part I — Leadership & Doctrine · Part II — Personnel, Programs & Justice · Part III — Fitness & Health · Part IV — Soldier Skills & Warfighting. Each regulation section has: a currency header, open-ended Q&A, and multiple-choice questions with answers.

Master Regulation Quick-Reference

The publication that governs each board subject. Memorize this table — it answers the most common “which reg covers...” questions.

Subject area	Governing publication	Title / note
Army Leadership	ADP 6-22	Army Leadership and the Profession
Leader Development	FM 6-22	Developing Leaders
Mission Command	ADP 6-0	Mission Command: Command and Control of Army Forces
Operations / Warfighting Functions	ADP 3-0	Operations (supersedes ADRP 3-0); see also FM 3-0 (2022)
Training	ADP 7-0	Training
The Army (profession)	ADP 1	The Army
NCO Duties / History	TC 7-22.7	The Noncommissioned Officer Guide (current 14 Aug 2025)
Counseling	ATP 6-22.1	The Counseling Process
Wear & Appearance (uniform)	AR 670-1 / DA PAM 670-1	Grooming updated by Sep 2025 directive
Enlisted Promotions & Reductions	AR 600-8-19	21 Jun 2024 (admin rev 17 Mar 2025)
Flags (Suspension of Favorable Actions)	AR 600-8-2	DA Form 268
Military Awards	AR 600-8-22	Decorations, awards, honors
Evaluations (NCOER/OER)	AR 623-3 / DA PAM 623-3	Evaluation Reporting System
Army Training & Leader Development	AR 350-1	Mandatory training; NCOPDS
Command Policy / EO / Chain of Command / SHARP	AR 600-20	Army Command Policy
Body Composition	AR 600-9	Army Body Composition Program
Customs & Courtesies (salutes/honors)	AR 600-25	Salutes, Honors, and Visits of Courtesy
Military Justice	AR 27-10	UCMJ administration; Article 15
Maintenance	AR 750-1 / DA PAM 750-1	Army Maintenance Policy
Holistic Health & Fitness / AFT	FM 7-22	H2F (replaced “Physical Readiness Training”)
First Aid	TC 4-02.1	First Aid
Field Hygiene & Sanitation	TC 4-02.3	Field Hygiene and Sanitation
Drill & Ceremonies	TC 3-21.5	Drill and Ceremonies
Map Reading & Land Navigation	TC 3-25.26	Map Reading and Land Navigation
Weapons (Rifle/Carbine)	TC 3-22.9	Rifle and Carbine (M4/M16)

Subject area	Governing publication	Title / note
CBRN	FM 3-11	Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear Operations
Law of War	FM 6-27	The Commander's Handbook on the Law of Land Warfare (replaced FM 27-10)
Code of Conduct	EO 10631 / DoD	Six articles — conduct of U.S. fighting forces

Recently changed — do not study from old guides: APFT -> **ACFT** -> **AFT** (1 Jun 2025); FM 7-22 is now **Holistic Health and Fitness**, not Physical Readiness Training; ADRP publications were folded into **ADPs** (2019); FM 27-10 was replaced by **FM 6-27**; the “mission command” warfighting function was renamed **command and control**.

Regulation Identification Drill

“What regulation / publication covers...?” — the highest-frequency board question type.

OPEN-ENDED

What publication covers Army Leadership?

- ADP 6-22, Army Leadership and the Profession.

What publication covers Mission Command?

- ADP 6-0.

What regulation covers wear and appearance of the uniform?

- AR 670-1 (with the “how-to” in DA PAM 670-1).

What regulation covers enlisted promotions and reductions?

- AR 600-8-19.

What regulation covers suspension of favorable personnel actions (flags)?

- AR 600-8-2.

What regulation covers military awards?

- AR 600-8-22.

What regulation covers the evaluation reporting system (NCOER)?

- AR 623-3 (procedures in DA PAM 623-3).

What regulation covers Army Command Policy, Equal Opportunity, and SHARP?

- AR 600-20.

What regulation covers the Army Body Composition Program?

- AR 600-9.

What regulation covers salutes, honors, and customs & courtesies?

- AR 600-25.

What regulation covers military justice / the Article 15?

- AR 27-10 (the punishment itself is Article 15, UCMJ).

What regulation covers Army training and leader development (mandatory training, NCO schools)?

- AR 350-1.

What publication covers Army counseling?

- ATP 6-22.1, The Counseling Process.

What publication covers the NCO guide and NCO history?

- TC 7-22.7.

What manual covers Holistic Health and Fitness?

- FM 7-22.

What publication covers drill and ceremonies?

- TC 3-21.5.

What publication covers map reading and land navigation?

- TC 3-25.26.

What publication covers the rifle and carbine?

- TC 3-22.9.

What manual covers CBRN operations?

- FM 3-11.

What manual covers the law of land warfare?

- FM 6-27 (replaced FM 27-10).

What publication covers maintenance?

- AR 750-1 (procedures in DA PAM 750-1).

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. Which regulation governs the wear and appearance of Army uniforms?

- A. AR 600-20
- B. AR 670-1
- C. AR 350-1
- D. AR 600-9

B — AR 670-1. DA PAM 670-1 provides the detailed illustrations.

2. Equal Opportunity and SHARP policy are found in which regulation?

- A. AR 600-20
- B. AR 27-10
- C. AR 600-8-19
- D. AR 623-3

A — AR 600-20, Army Command Policy.

3. The Army Body Composition Program is governed by:

- A. FM 7-22
- B. AR 350-1
- C. AR 600-9
- D. AR 600-8-2

C — AR 600-9. FM 7-22 covers fitness/training, not the body-composition standard.

4. Which publication is “The Counseling Process”?

- A. ADP 6-22
- B. ATP 6-22.1
- C. TC 7-22.7
- D. AR 623-3

B — ATP 6-22.1.

5. Nonjudicial punishment (Article 15) is administered under:

- A. AR 600-8-2
- B. AR 27-10
- C. AR 600-8-22
- D. AR 600-25

B — AR 27-10, Military Justice (Article 15 of the UCMJ).

PART I · Leadership & Doctrine

ADP 6-22

Army Leadership and the Profession

Current edition: ADP 6-22, 31 July 2019. The Army's capstone leadership doctrine.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does ADP 6-22 cover?

- Army Leadership and the Profession — the principles of leadership and the Army profession.

Define leadership.

- The activity of influencing people by providing purpose, direction, and motivation to accomplish the mission and improve the organization.

What are the three leader attributes (what a leader IS — “Be/Know”)?

- Character, Presence, Intellect.

What are the three leader competencies (what a leader DOES)?

- Leads, Develops, Achieves.

What makes up Character?

- Army Values, empathy, the Warrior Ethos and service ethos, discipline, and humility.

What makes up Presence?

- Military and professional bearing, fitness, confidence, and resilience.

What makes up Intellect?

- Mental agility, sound judgment, innovation, interpersonal tact, and expertise.

What are the three levels of leadership?

- Direct, Organizational, and Strategic.

What are the seven Army Values?

- Loyalty, Duty, Respect, Selfless Service, Honor, Integrity, Personal Courage (LDRSHIP).

Recite the Warrior Ethos.

- I will always place the mission first. I will never accept defeat. I will never quit. I will never leave a fallen comrade.

What are the two types of personal courage?

- Physical courage and moral courage.

Under “Leads,” what are the competencies?

- Leads others, builds trust, extends influence beyond the chain of command, leads by example, and communicates.

Under “Develops,” what are the competencies?

- Creates a positive environment / fosters esprit de corps, prepares self, develops others, and stewards the profession.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The three leader attributes are:

- A. Leads, Develops, Achieves
- B. Character, Presence, Intellect
- C. Loyalty, Duty, Respect
- D. Direct, Organizational, Strategic

B. Attributes = what a leader IS. (Leads/Develops/Achieves are the competencies.)

2. Which is a core leader competency?

- A. Presence
- B. Character
- C. Achieves
- D. Intellect

C — Achieves. The others are attributes.

3. How many Army Values are there?

- A. 5
- B. 6
- C. 7
- D. 8

C — 7 (LDRSHIP).

4. The three levels of leadership are direct, organizational, and:

- A. Tactical
- B. Strategic
- C. Operational
- D. Executive

B — Strategic.

Developing Leaders (Leader Development)

FM 6-22, Leader Development. Companion to ADP 6-22; the “how-to” of developing leaders. *Verify edition locally.*

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does FM 6-22 cover?

- Leader development — how leaders develop themselves and others.

What are the three domains of leader development?

- Institutional, operational, and self-development.

What are the three pillars/means of developing a leader?

- Education, training, and experience.

What are the fundamentals of leader development?

- Set conditions for leadership; provide feedback, coaching, counseling, and mentoring; and create opportunities through challenging experiences.

What is mentorship?

- The voluntary developmental relationship between a person of greater experience and one of lesser experience, characterized by mutual trust and respect.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The three leader-development domains are institutional, self-development, and:

- A. Operational
- B. Strategic
- C. Generating
- D. Tactical

A — Operational.

2. Mentorship is best described as:

- A. A mandatory rated relationship
- B. A voluntary relationship built on mutual trust and respect
- C. Formal classroom instruction
- D. A type of counseling form

B. Mentorship is voluntary and future-focused.

Mission Command: Command and Control

Current edition: ADP 6-0, 31 July 2019.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does ADP 6-0 cover?

- Mission command — the Army's approach to command and control.

Define mission command.

- The Army's approach to command and control that empowers subordinate decision making and decentralized execution appropriate to the situation.

What are the seven principles of mission command?

- Competence, mutual trust, shared understanding, commander's intent, mission orders, disciplined initiative, and risk acceptance.

What is command and control?

- The exercise of authority and direction by a properly designated commander over assigned and attached forces in the accomplishment of the mission.

What is commander's intent?

- A clear and concise expression of the purpose of the operation and the desired military end state that supports mission command.

What is disciplined initiative?

- Action in the absence of orders, when existing orders no longer fit, or when unforeseen opportunities or threats arise — consistent with the commander's intent.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. How many principles of mission command are there?

- A. 5
- B. 6
- C. 7
- D. 8

C — 7.

2. Which is NOT a principle of mission command?

- A. Mutual trust
- B. Mission orders
- C. Centralized execution
- D. Risk acceptance

C. Mission command emphasizes *decentralized* execution.

3. Mission command empowers subordinates through:

- A. Detailed step-by-step orders
- B. Mission orders and commander's intent
- C. Removing all risk
- D. Higher-headquarters approval of every decision

B.

Operations & the Warfighting Functions

ADP 3-0, Operations, 31 July 2019 (supersedes ADRP 3-0). See also FM 3-0, Operations (Oct 2022) for current tenets.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What are the six warfighting functions?

- Command and control, movement and maneuver, intelligence, fires, sustainment, and protection. (“Mission command” was renamed **command and control** in 2019.)

What is a warfighting function?

- A group of tasks and systems united by a common purpose that commanders use to accomplish missions and training objectives.

What are the four elements of decisive action?

- Offense, defense, stability, and defense support of civil authorities (DSCA).

What are the eight elements of combat power?

- The six warfighting functions plus the two dynamics of **leadership** and **information**.

What are the tenets of operations in FM 3-0 (2022)?

- Agility, convergence, endurance, and depth.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. Which is one of the six warfighting functions?

- A. Leadership
- B. Information
- C. Sustainment
- D. Training

C — Sustainment. Leadership and information are the two dynamics of combat power, not warfighting functions.

2. The four elements of decisive action are offense, defense, stability, and:

- A. DSCA
- B. Deterrence
- C. Reconnaissance
- D. Mobilization

A — DSCA (Defense Support of Civil Authorities).

Training

ADP 7-0, Training, 31 July 2019.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does ADP 7-0 cover?

- Training units and developing leaders.

Who is responsible for training?

- Commanders. NCOs train individuals, crews, and small teams.

What can a commander delegate?

- Authority, but never responsibility.

What method does the unit training plan use?

- Crawl–walk–run.

What is METL?

- Mission-Essential Task List — the doctrinal framework of the tasks a unit must perform to accomplish its mission.

What are the three training domains?

- Institutional, operational, and self-development.

Name key principles of training.

- Train as you fight; train to standard; train to sustain; train to maintain; train to develop adaptability; commanders are responsible for training; NCOs train individuals, crews, and small teams. *(Verify exact list against current ADP 7-0.)*

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The unit training plan is built using which method?

- A. Plan–prepare–execute
- B. Crawl–walk–run
- C. Assess–train–retest
- D. Top–down only

B — Crawl–walk–run.

2. A commander may delegate:

- A. Responsibility
- B. Authority
- C. Both
- D. Neither

B — Authority, but not responsibility.

3. NCOs are primarily responsible for training:

- A. Brigades
- B. Battalions
- C. Individuals, crews, and small teams
- D. Division staffs

C.

The Army

ADP 1, The Army, 31 July 2019.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does ADP 1 cover?

- The Army — its purpose, the profession, and how it serves the Nation.

What are the characteristics of the Army profession?

- Trust, military expertise, honorable service, esprit de corps, and stewardship of the profession.

What components make up the Army?

- One Regular Army and two reserve components — the Army National Guard and the Army Reserve (supported by Army Civilians). Established under Title 10, U.S. Code.

What is the difference between the operating force and the generating force?

- The operating force consists of units organized, trained, and equipped to deploy and fight; the generating force mans, trains, equips, and ensures the readiness of all Army forces.

What is the Army's greatest strategic asset?

- The all-volunteer force / its Soldiers.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The Army consists of one Regular Army and how many reserve components?

- A. One
- B. Two
- C. Three
- D. Four

B — Two (Army National Guard and Army Reserve).

2. Which is a characteristic of the Army profession?

- A. Stewardship
- B. Centralization
- C. Bureaucracy
- D. Seniority

A — Stewardship (also trust, military expertise, honorable service, esprit de corps).

The Noncommissioned Officer Guide

Current as of 14 Aug 2025. Covers NCO duties, responsibilities, authority, and NCO history.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What are the three types of duty?

- Specified, directed, and implied.

What are the two basic responsibilities of every leader?

- Accomplishment of the mission and the welfare of Soldiers.

What are the two types of authority?

- Command authority and general military authority.

What is the NCO support channel?

- The channel of communication and supervision that runs from the senior NCO (CSM) through subordinate NCOs; it parallels and reinforces the chain of command.

When was the U.S. Army established?

- 14 June 1775.

Who is considered the “Father of the NCO Corps”?

- Baron Friedrich von Steuben, who wrote the “Blue Book” (Regulations for the Order and Discipline of the Troops of the United States, 1778).

What are the three ranks the NCO Corps is often described by?

- The NCO is the “backbone of the Army.” Corporal (E-4) is the first NCO rank; the Sergeant Major of the Army is the senior enlisted Soldier.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The three types of duty are specified, implied, and:

- A. Directed
- B. Assumed
- C. Voluntary
- D. General

A — Directed.

2. The first noncommissioned officer rank is:

- A. Specialist (E-4)
- B. Corporal (E-4)
- C. Sergeant (E-5)
- D. Private First Class (E-3)

B — Corporal (E-4). A Specialist is E-4 but is not an NCO.

3. The U.S. Army was established on:

- A. 4 July 1776
- B. 14 June 1775
- C. 11 November 1918
- D. 14 June 1777

B — 14 June 1775.

The Counseling Process

ATP 6-22.1, The Counseling Process. Counseling form: DA Form 4856.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

Define counseling.

- The process used by leaders to review with a subordinate the subordinate's demonstrated performance and potential.

What are the three approaches to counseling?

- Directive, nondirective, and combined.

What are the three major categories of developmental counseling?

- Event counseling, performance counseling, and professional growth counseling.

What are the four stages of the counseling process?

- Identify the need for counseling; prepare for counseling; conduct the counseling session; follow up.

What are the qualities of an effective counselor?

- Purpose, flexibility, respect, communication, and support.

What form is used to document counseling?

- DA Form 4856, Developmental Counseling Form.

Give examples of event counseling.

- Reception & integration, crisis, referral, promotion, transition, adverse separation, and superior/substandard performance counseling.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The three approaches to counseling are directive, combined, and:

- A. Nondirective
- B. Corrective
- C. Crisis
- D. Formal

A — Nondirective.

2. Which form documents developmental counseling?

- A. DA Form 705
- B. DA Form 4856
- C. DA Form 268
- D. DA Form 2166-9

B — DA Form 4856.

3. The three categories of developmental counseling are event, performance, and:

- A. Professional growth
- B. Crisis
- C. Referral
- D. Adverse

A — Professional growth. (Crisis/referral/adverse are *types of event* counseling.)

PART II · Personnel, Programs & Justice

AR 670-1 / DA PAM 670-1

Wear and Appearance of Army Uniforms and Insignia

AR 670-1 current as of 2025; grooming/appearance standards substantially revised by the Army directive signed 12 September 2025 (Soldiers had 30 days to comply). Always confirm the latest directive.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 670-1 cover?

- The wear and appearance of Army uniforms and insignia. DA PAM 670-1 provides the detailed “how-to” and illustrations.

(2025 update) What are the current standards for women's ponytails/braids?

- No wider than two inches and must hang within six inches from the top of the collar; ponytails are authorized only in the ACU and physical fitness uniform — not in dress uniforms.

(2025 update) What are the current female nail standards?

- Clear polish only; length limited to ¼ inch, in a square or rounded shape.

(2025 update) What are the female cosmetic/lip standards?

- No lipstick or colored nail polish; only clear or skin-toned lip gloss is authorized.

(2025 update) What are the female earring rules?

- One per ear — gold, silver, diamond, or pearl studs — authorized with dress and combat uniforms.

(2025 update) What are the male hair standards?

- Tapered or faded, evenly blended around the sides and back; maximum about two inches on top and one inch on the sides and back.

(2025 update) May male Soldiers wear nail polish?

- No. Male Soldiers may not wear nail polish; nails are neatly trimmed and not past the fingertip.

Who is responsible for ensuring Soldiers maintain uniform/appearance standards?

- Commanders and leaders at all levels — but ultimately every Soldier is responsible for their own appearance.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. Under the 2025 standards, female nail polish may be:

- A. Any conservative color
- B. Clear only
- C. Red or pink
- D. French manicure

B — Clear only, ¼-inch maximum length.

2. Under the 2025 standards, ponytails are authorized in which uniforms?

- A. All uniforms
- B. Dress uniforms only
- C. ACU and physical fitness uniform only
- D. None

C. Not authorized with dress uniforms.

3. The detailed illustrations for wearing the uniform are found in:

- A. AR 670-1**
- B. DA PAM 670-1**
- C. AR 600-20**
- D. TC 3-21.5**

B — DA PAM 670-1.

Enlisted Promotions and Reductions

Current edition: 21 June 2024 (effective 21 July 2024); administrative revision 17 March 2025.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-8-19 cover?

- Enlisted promotions and reductions.

Which promotions are semi-centralized vs. centralized?

- SGT (E-5) and SSG (E-6) are **semi-centralized** (point-based); SFC (E-7) through SGM (E-9) are **centralized** (HQDA board).

What is the maximum number of promotion points for SGT and SSG?

- 800 points total for each grade.

What is the maximum for civilian education?

- 135 points for SGT and 160 points for SSG.

What is the primary zone vs. secondary zone?

- The primary zone is normal eligibility; the secondary zone allows early (accelerated) consideration for high-performing Soldiers.

Who has promotion authority for SGT/SSG?

- The battalion (or equivalent) commander, per the HQDA point cutoff.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. Promotions to SGT and SSG are:

- A. Centralized (HQDA board)
 - B. Semi-centralized (point-based)
 - C. Automatic
 - D. Decentralized to the squad
- B. Semi-centralized via the promotion-point system.**

2. The maximum promotion points for SGT/SSG is:

- A. 600
 - B. 700
 - C. 800
 - D. 1000
- C — 800.**

Suspension of Favorable Personnel Actions (Flags)

AR 600-8-2. Flag is initiated/removed on DA Form 268.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-8-2 cover?

- Suspension of favorable personnel actions — commonly called a “flag.”

What form is used to flag a Soldier?

- DA Form 268.

What favorable actions does a flag stop?

- Promotion, awards, schooling, reassignment (PCS), reenlistment/extension, favorable separation, and similar favorable actions.

What is the difference between a transferable and nontransferable flag?

- A transferable flag (e.g., commander's investigation) moves with the Soldier on PCS; a nontransferable flag (e.g., APFT/AFT failure, adverse action) generally must be resolved before transfer.

How soon must a flag be reviewed?

- Flags are reviewed periodically (monthly) and removed within the prescribed time after the circumstance is resolved. *Verify current timelines.*

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. A flag is initiated using:

- A. DA Form 4856
- B. DA Form 268
- C. DA Form 705
- D. DA Form 638

B — DA Form 268.

2. Which favorable action does a flag suspend?

- A. Promotion
- B. Pay
- C. Meal card
- D. Sick call

A — Promotion (and awards, schooling, PCS, reenlistment, etc.).

Military Awards

AR 600-8-22, Military Awards. Recommendations generally submitted within 2 years of the act/period.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-8-22 cover?

- Military awards — decorations, service medals, badges, and the order of precedence.

What is the highest U.S. military award for valor?

- The Medal of Honor.

What is the highest Army award for valor below the Medal of Honor?

- The Distinguished Service Cross.

What does the “V” device denote?

- Valor — participation in acts of heroism involving conflict with an armed enemy.

What form is used to recommend an award?

- DA Form 638, Recommendation for Award.

What is the time limit to submit most award recommendations?

- Within two years of the act, achievement, or service; the award must be presented within three years.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The highest U.S. military decoration is the:

- A. Silver Star
- B. Distinguished Service Cross
- C. Medal of Honor
- D. Bronze Star

C — Medal of Honor.

2. An award is recommended using:

- A. DA Form 638
- B. DA Form 4856
- C. DA Form 268
- D. DA Form 31

A — DA Form 638.

Evaluation Reporting System (NCOER / OER)

AR 623-3, Evaluation Reporting System; procedures in DA PAM 623-3. NCOER uses the DA Form 2166-9 series.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 623-3 cover?

- The Army's Evaluation Reporting System — NCOERs and OERs.

What is the purpose of the NCOER?

- To document an NCO's performance and potential, strengthen the NCO corps, and provide selection boards/HRC data for personnel decisions.

What forms make up the NCOER?

- The DA Form 2166-9 series (2166-9-1 for SGT, 2166-9-2 for SSG–1SG/MSG, 2166-9-3 for CSM/SGM).

Who is in the NCOER rating chain?

- The rater, the senior rater, and the reviewer (and the rated NCO).

What is a rating scheme/published rating chain?

- The documented designation of who rates, senior rates, and reviews each Soldier.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The NCOER is documented on the:

- A. DA Form 705 series
- B. DA Form 2166-9 series
- C. DA Form 638
- D. DA Form 4856

B — DA Form 2166-9 series.

2. The NCOER rating chain consists of the rater, the reviewer, and the:

- A. First Sergeant
- B. Senior rater
- C. Command Sergeant Major
- D. S1

B — Senior rater.

Army Training and Leader Development

AR 350-1, Army Training and Leader Development. Governs mandatory training and the NCO Professional Development System.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 350-1 cover?

- Army training and leader development — including mandatory/common military training and the NCO Professional Development System (NCOPDS).

What are the levels of the Noncommissioned Officer Professional Military Education (NCOPME)?

- BLC (Basic Leader Course), ALC (Advanced Leader Course), SLC (Senior Leader Course), MLC (Master Leader Course), and the SMA Academy / USASMA (Sergeants Major Course).

What course is required for promotion to Sergeant?

- The Basic Leader Course (BLC).

Give examples of mandatory/common military training.

- SHARP, EO, suicide prevention/ACE, OPSEC, information security, resilience, and similar HQDA-directed training.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The first level of NCO professional military education is:

- A. ALC
- B. BLC
- C. SLC
- D. MLC

B — BLC (Basic Leader Course).

2. Which regulation governs mandatory training and NCO schools?

- A. AR 600-20
- B. AR 350-1
- C. AR 670-1
- D. AR 623-3

B — AR 350-1.

Army Command Policy (Chain of Command, EO, SHARP)

AR 600-20, Army Command Policy. Includes the chain of command/NCO support channel, Equal Opportunity, and SHARP.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-20 cover?

- Army Command Policy — command authority, the chain of command and NCO support channel, the Equal Opportunity (EO) program, SHARP, and prohibited conduct (hazing, bullying, extremism).

What is the chain of command?

- The succession of commanders, superior to subordinate, through which command is exercised — the “backbone” of military authority.

What is the NCO support channel?

- The channel of supervision from the CSM through the chain of NCOs that parallels and reinforces the chain of command.

What does SHARP stand for?

- Sexual Harassment/Assault Response and Prevention.

What are the two types of sexual-assault report?

- Restricted (confidential, no command/law-enforcement notification) and Unrestricted (triggers investigation and command notification).

What is the purpose of the EO program?

- To provide equal opportunity and fair treatment for military personnel and Family members without regard to race, color, religion, gender, or national origin, and to create a climate free of unlawful discrimination.

Define hazing and bullying.

- Hazing is conduct that subjects a Soldier to abuse/humiliation as a rite of passage; bullying is aggressive behavior intended to harm or intimidate. Both are prohibited.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. SHARP stands for:

- A. Soldier Harassment and Retaliation Prevention
- B. Sexual Harassment/Assault Response and Prevention
- C. Soldier Health and Readiness Program
- D. Safety Hazard and Risk Prevention

B.

2. The two types of sexual-assault reporting are:

- A. Open and closed
- B. Restricted and unrestricted
- C. Formal and informal
- D. Verbal and written

B — Restricted and unrestricted.

3. The NCO support channel:

- A. Replaces the chain of command
- B. Parallels and reinforces the chain of command
- C. Only exists in combat
- D. Reports to no one

B.

Salutes, Honors, and Visits of Courtesy (Customs & Courtesies)

AR 600-25, Salutes, Honors, and Visits of Courtesy.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-25 cover?

- Military customs and courtesies — salutes, honors, and visits of courtesy.

What is the difference between a custom and a courtesy?

- A custom is an established practice (tradition); a courtesy is an act of politeness/respect (e.g., the salute).

Whom do you salute?

- Commissioned and warrant officers, the President, and recipients of the Medal of Honor; also render honors to the U.S. flag and national anthem.

When do you NOT salute?

- Indoors (unless reporting), when in formation (only on command), when carrying articles with both hands, in combat/tactical conditions, or when it is impractical/unsafe.

What do you do during Reveille and Retreat?

- Render honors to the flag — come to attention and salute (when in uniform and outdoors) during the national anthem/"To the Color."

What are the three general orders... (commonly tested)?

- 1) I will guard everything within the limits of my post and quit my post only when properly relieved. 2) I will obey my special orders and perform all my duties in a military manner. 3) I will report violations of my special orders, emergencies, and anything not covered in my instructions to the commander of the relief.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. You are required to salute all of the following EXCEPT:

- A. A commissioned officer
- B. A warrant officer
- C. A Medal of Honor recipient
- D. A fellow Specialist

D. Salutes are rendered to officers, warrant officers, and MOH recipients.

2. When are you generally NOT required to salute?

- A. Outdoors on post
- B. Indoors, unless reporting
- C. During the national anthem outdoors
- D. When meeting your commander outside

B.

Military Justice

AR 27-10, Military Justice (administers the UCMJ).

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 27-10 cover?

- The administration of military justice under the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ).

What is an Article 15?

- Nonjudicial punishment (NJP) — a commander's tool to discipline Soldiers for minor offenses without a court-martial.

What are the three types of court-martial?

- Summary, Special, and General.

What are the categories/levels of Article 15?

- Summarized, Company-grade (field-grade in some contexts), and Field-grade — differing in the maximum punishment authorized.

May a Soldier refuse an Article 15?

- Yes (except aboard a vessel) — the Soldier may demand trial by court-martial instead.

What does UCMJ stand for?

- Uniform Code of Military Justice.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The three types of court-martial are summary, general, and:

- A. Special
- B. Field
- C. Summarized
- D. Standard

A — Special.

2. Nonjudicial punishment is also known as:

- A. A flag
- B. An Article 15
- C. A counseling
- D. A reduction board

B — Article 15.

Army Maintenance

AR 750-1, Army Materiel Maintenance Policy; DA PAM 750-1 (TAMMS users' manual).

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 750-1 cover?

- Army materiel maintenance policy.

What are the two levels of the Army maintenance system?

- Field maintenance and sustainment maintenance.

What does PMCS stand for?

- Preventive Maintenance Checks and Services.

When is PMCS performed?

- Before, during, and after operation (and weekly/monthly as required).

What form documents equipment faults / PMCS?

- DA Form 5988-E (or DA Form 2404) for inspection/maintenance worksheets; DA Form 2407 for maintenance requests.

What is a “-10” manual?

- The operator's technical manual (TM). A “-20” is the field-maintenance level manual.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The two levels of Army maintenance are field and:

- A. Depot
- B. Sustainment
- C. Organizational
- D. Direct

B — Sustainment. (The Army moved to a two-level system.)

2. PMCS stands for:

- A. Preventive Maintenance Checks and Services
- B. Property Management Control System
- C. Primary Maintenance Class Schedule
- D. Periodic Mechanical Condition Survey

A.

PART III · Fitness & Health

FM 7-22 · AFT

Holistic Health and Fitness (H2F) & the Army Fitness Test

FM 7-22, Holistic Health and Fitness (Oct 2020) — replaced “Army Physical Readiness Training.” The **Army Fitness Test (AFT)** replaced the ACFT on **1 June 2025**.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does FM 7-22 cover?

- Holistic Health and Fitness (H2F) — the Army's system for building and sustaining Soldier readiness. *(Note: older guides incorrectly say “Physical Readiness Training” — that is outdated.)*

What are the five domains of H2F?

- Physical, nutritional, mental, spiritual, and sleep readiness.

What test replaced the ACFT, and when?

- The Army Fitness Test (AFT), effective 1 June 2025.

What are the five AFT events?

- 3-Repetition Maximum Deadlift (MDL), Hand-Release Push-Up (HRP), Sprint-Drag-Carry (SDC), Plank (PLK), and the 2-Mile Run (2MR).

What event was removed from the old ACFT to create the AFT?

- The Standing Power Throw (the medicine-ball throw).

What are the AFT scoring standards?

- Combat MOS: one sex-neutral, age-normed standard requiring a total of **350** with a minimum of **60 per event**.
Combat-enabling MOS: sex- and age-normed, requiring a total of **300**.

How many points is each AFT event worth?

- Each event is scored 0–100, for a maximum of 500 points (five events).

What are the three fundamental components of physical readiness?

- Strength, endurance, and mobility.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. How many events are in the Army Fitness Test (AFT)?

- A. 4
- B. 5
- C. 6
- D. 3

B — 5. The standing power throw was removed from the old 6-event ACFT.

2. The minimum total AFT score for combat-MOS Soldiers is:

- A. 300
- B. 350
- C. 360
- D. 400

B — 350 (with at least 60 points per event, sex-neutral/age-normed).

3. FM 7-22 currently covers:

- A. Physical Readiness Training
- B. Holistic Health and Fitness
- C. The Army Body Composition Program
- D. Drill and Ceremonies

B — Holistic Health and Fitness. “PRT” is the outdated title.

4. The five domains of H2F include all EXCEPT:

- A. Sleep
- B. Nutritional
- C. Financial
- D. Spiritual

C — Financial. The five are physical, nutritional, mental, spiritual, sleep.

The Army Body Composition Program (ABCP)

AR 600-9. Standards updated 2023–2026: one-site (abdominal) circumference tape and a Waist-to-Height Ratio (WHtR) standard. Confirm the current ALARACT/directive.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does AR 600-9 cover?

- The Army Body Composition Program — height/weight screening and body-fat standards.

What circumference method does the Army currently use?

- A one-site abdominal (waist) circumference tape method for both men and women (adopted 9 June 2023; sole method since 2024).

Where and how is the abdominal measurement taken?

- Against the skin at the navel, parallel to the floor, at the end of a normal relaxed exhalation; three measurements are averaged.

What is the new Waist-to-Height Ratio (WHtR) standard?

- Waist circumference (at the navel) divided by height must be less than **0.55**. *(Per 2025–2026 directives — verify locally.)*

Who is exempt from the tape/body-fat assessment?

- Soldiers who achieve a high fitness-test score per the current directive (historically 540+ with 80+ per event on the record ACFT) — confirm the current AFT-based exemption threshold.

How often are Soldiers assessed?

- Active component at least every 6 months; Reserve/Guard annually or as required.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The current Army circumference (tape) method measures:

- A. Neck and waist
 - B. One site — the abdomen (waist)
 - C. Three sites
 - D. Neck, waist, and hip
- B. The Army moved to a one-site abdominal method in 2023–2024.**

2. The Waist-to-Height Ratio standard requires a ratio of less than:

- A. 0.45
 - B. 0.50
 - C. 0.55
 - D. 0.60
- C — 0.55 (verify against the current directive).**

3. How often is an active-duty Soldier assessed under the ABCP?

- A. Monthly
 - B. Every 6 months
 - C. Annually
 - D. Every 2 years
- B — Every 6 months.**

First Aid

TC 4-02.1, First Aid (aligns with Tactical Combat Casualty Care — TCCC).

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does TC 4-02.1 cover?

- First aid — the emergency care a Soldier gives to prevent death or further injury.

What are the three phases of Tactical Combat Casualty Care (TCCC)?

- Care Under Fire, Tactical Field Care, and Tactical Evacuation Care.

What does the MARCH acronym stand for?

- Massive hemorrhage, Airway, Respiration, Circulation, Head injury/Hypothermia.

What is the #1 cause of preventable death on the battlefield?

- Massive hemorrhage (severe bleeding from an extremity) — treated first, often with a tourniquet.

What are the four life-saving steps / priorities of first aid?

- Open the airway/restore breathing, stop the bleeding, prevent/treat for shock, and dress/protect the wound.

How long can a tourniquet generally be left on, and what must you do?

- Apply tight enough to stop bleeding, mark the time ("T" and time), and never cover it; reassessment/conversion is done by medical personnel.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The MARCH algorithm begins with treating:

- A. Airway
- B. Massive hemorrhage
- C. Respiration
- D. Circulation

B — Massive hemorrhage.

2. The three phases of TCCC are Care Under Fire, Tactical Field Care, and:

- A. Tactical Evacuation Care
- B. Hospital Care
- C. Recovery Care
- D. Buddy Care

A.

Field Hygiene and Sanitation

TC 4-02.3, Field Hygiene and Sanitation.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does TC 4-02.3 cover?

- Field hygiene and sanitation — preventive medicine measures (PMM) that keep Soldiers healthy and the force combat-ready.

What is the leading cause of casualties historically — combat or disease/non-battle injury?

- Disease and non-battle injury (DNBI) — which is why field sanitation matters.

What is the Field Sanitation Team (FST)?

- A unit-level team (minimum two trained members) that advises the commander on preventive medicine measures.

What are the five preventive medicine measures (individual)?

- Practice personal hygiene; protect against heat/cold injuries; protect against arthropods/insects (use repellent, treat uniforms); purify/drink safe water; avoid foodborne illness.

What is the chain of disease transmission concept?

- Break the chain — agent, reservoir, and means of transmission — through PMM to prevent illness.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The Field Sanitation Team advises the:

- A. Commander
- B. Surgeon General
- C. Squad leader only
- D. S1

A — Commander.

2. Historically, most casualties in military operations are caused by:

- A. Direct combat
- B. Disease and non-battle injury
- C. Vehicle accidents
- D. Friendly fire

B — DNBI.

PART IV · Soldier Skills & Warfighting

TC 3-21.5

Drill and Ceremonies

TC 3-21.5, Drill and Ceremonies.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does TC 3-21.5 cover?

- Drill and ceremonies — the movements and procedures for moving and presenting units.

What are the two parts of a drill command?

- The preparatory command (e.g., “Forward”) and the command of execution (e.g., “MARCH”).

What is the difference between a two-part command and a combined command?

- A two-part command has a preparatory command and a command of execution; a combined command has them in one (e.g., “FALL IN,” “AT EASE”).

What is cadence?

- The uniform step and rhythm of marching — quick time is 120 steps per minute; double time is 180 steps per minute.

What is the length of a 30-inch step at quick time?

- The standard marching step is 30 inches at 120 steps per minute (quick time).

What is the difference between “At Ease” and “Rest”?

- At Ease — keep the right foot in place, may move/relax but remain silent; Rest — keep the right foot in place but may talk.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The two parts of a drill command are the preparatory command and the:

- A. Command of execution
- B. Combined command
- C. Supplementary command
- D. Directive

A.

2. Quick time cadence is:

- A. 100 steps/min
- B. 120 steps/min
- C. 180 steps/min
- D. 60 steps/min

B — 120 steps per minute (double time is 180).

Map Reading and Land Navigation

TC 3-25.26, Map Reading and Land Navigation.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does TC 3-25.26 cover?

- Map reading and land navigation.

What are the five major terrain features?

- Hill, ridge, valley, saddle, and depression.

What are the three minor terrain features?

- Draw, spur, and cliff.

What are the two supplementary terrain features?

- Cut and fill.

What are the five basic colors on a military map and what do they represent?

- Black (man-made), Blue (water), Green (vegetation), Brown (contours/relief), Red (major roads/boundaries). (Red-brown on some maps.)

What are the three norths?

- True north, magnetic north, and grid north.

How do you read a grid coordinate?

- Read right (easting), then up (northing) — “right and up.”

What is a contour line?

- A line on a map joining points of equal elevation; the three types are index, intermediate, and supplementary.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. How many major terrain features are there?

- A. 3
- B. 5
- C. 8
- D. 10

B — 5 (hill, ridge, valley, saddle, depression).

2. On a military map, blue represents:

- A. Vegetation
- B. Water
- C. Man-made features
- D. Elevation

B — Water.

3. Grid coordinates are read:

- A. Up and right
- B. Right and up
- C. Left and down
- D. Down and left

B — Right and up.

Rifle and Carbine (Weapons — M4/M16)

TC 3-22.9, Rifle and Carbine.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does TC 3-22.9 cover?

- The rifle and carbine (M4/M16 family) — employment, marksmanship, and maintenance.

What is the maximum effective range of the M4 carbine against a point target?

- Approximately 500 meters (point target); about 600 meters for an area target.

What are the four fundamentals of marksmanship?

- Steady position, aim (sight alignment/sight picture), breathing (control), and trigger squeeze.

What is the cycle of function of the rifle (8 steps)?

- Feeding, chambering, locking, firing, unlocking, extracting, ejecting, and cocking.

What does SPORTS stand for (immediate action)?

- Slap, Pull, Observe, Release, Tap, Squeeze (Shoot).

What is the cyclic rate of fire of the M4?

- Approximately 700–970 rounds per minute (cyclic); sustained rate is much lower (~12–15 rpm).

What are the weapons safety rules?

- Treat every weapon as if loaded; never point at anything you don't intend to engage; keep your finger off the trigger until ready to fire; keep the weapon on safe until you intend to fire.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. SPORTS stands for:

- A. Slap, Pull, Observe, Release, Tap, Squeeze
- B. Stop, Pull, Open, Reload, Tap, Shoot
- C. Slap, Push, Observe, Reset, Tap, Squeeze
- D. Set, Pull, Observe, Release, Test, Shoot

A.

2. How many steps are in the cycle of function?

- A. 6
- B. 7
- C. 8
- D. 9

C — 8.

3. The four fundamentals of marksmanship include all EXCEPT:

- A. Steady position
- B. Breathing
- C. Trigger squeeze
- D. Reloading

D. The fourth is aim (sight picture).

CBRN Operations

FM 3-11, Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear Operations.

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

What does CBRN stand for?

- Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear.

What are the MOPP levels?

- MOPP Ready, MOPP 0, MOPP 1, MOPP 2, MOPP 3, and MOPP 4 (increasing levels of protective posture).

What is worn at MOPP 4?

- Overgarment, overboots, mask with hood, and gloves — full protection.

What protective mask does the Army use?

- The M50/M53 Joint Service General Purpose Mask (JSGPM).

What are the three types of decontamination?

- Immediate, operational, and thorough decontamination.

What are the standard CBRN marker (NATO) colors?

- Yellow with red letters = Chemical (“GAS”); blue with red letters = Biological (“BIO”); white with black letters = Radiological (“ATOM”).

What report is used to give first warning of a CBRN attack?

- The CBRN 1 Report (NBC-1).

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The highest level of protective posture is:

- A. MOPP 1
- B. MOPP 2
- C. MOPP 3
- D. MOPP 4

D — MOPP 4 (full ensemble).

2. The Army's general-purpose protective mask is the:

- A. M40
- B. M50
- C. M17
- D. M9

B — M50 (M53 for combat-vehicle crews).

Code of Conduct & the Law of Land Warfare

Code of Conduct — Executive Order 10631 (six articles). Law of war: FM 6-27, The Commander's Handbook on the Law of Land Warfare (replaced FM 27-10).

OPEN-ENDED Q&A

How many articles are in the Code of Conduct?

- Six.

Recite Article I of the Code of Conduct.

- “I am an American, fighting in the forces which guard my country and our way of life. I am prepared to give my life in their defense.”

What is the essence of Article II?

- “I will never surrender of my own free will. If in command, I will never surrender the members of my command while they still have the means to resist.”

If captured, what information are you required to give (Article V)?

- Name, rank, service number, and date of birth — and nothing else harmful to your country.

What manual covers the law of land warfare?

- FM 6-27 (it replaced the older FM 27-10).

What are the “5 S's and a T” for handling detainees/EPWs?

- Search, Silence, Segregate, Safeguard, Speed to the rear, and Tag.

What are the basic principles of the law of war?

- Military necessity, distinction (discrimination), proportionality, humanity (avoiding unnecessary suffering), and honor.

MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. The Code of Conduct has how many articles?

- A. 4
- B. 5
- C. 6
- D. 7

C — 6.

2. The current manual on the law of land warfare is:

- A. FM 27-10
- B. FM 6-27
- C. FM 3-11
- D. FM 6-22

B — FM 6-27. FM 27-10 is superseded.

3. The “5 S's and a T” for handling detainees are Search, Silence, Segregate, Safeguard, Speed to the rear, and:

- A. Tag
- B. Transport
- C. Treat
- D. Track

A — Tag.

Final Notes & Sources

STUDY TIPS

- Practice answers **out loud** — boards are oral.
- Lead with the publication: “Per AR 670-1...” shows you know the source.
- Master the Regulation Quick-Reference table — it covers the most common questions.
- Prioritize the high-change topics: **AFT**, **AR 600-9 (WHtR)**, and the **2025 AR 670-1 grooming standards**.

PRIMARY SOURCES

Army Publishing Directorate (armypubs.army.mil) is the source of truth for every answer. The fitness/standards facts in this guide were cross-checked against army.mil (AFT announcement), and reputable board-study references. Confirm the current edition of each publication before your board, and verify any item marked “verify locally” with your board NCO.

Unofficial study aid — not a substitute for the regulations. Compiled for Soldier Hub, June 2026. Regulations change; always confirm against the official publication and your chain of command.